2009 Toyota Camry

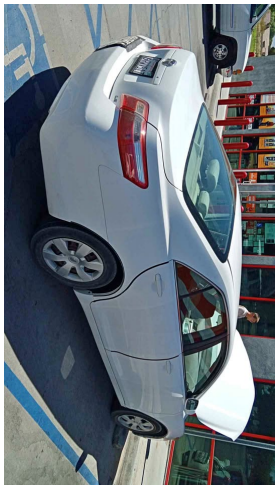
$5,000 · 148,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

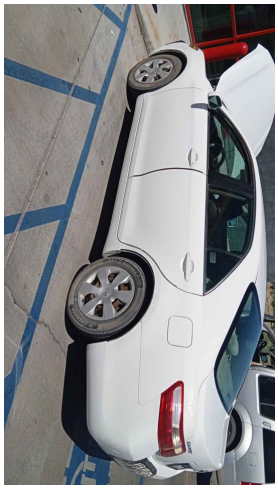
Seller: Private seller

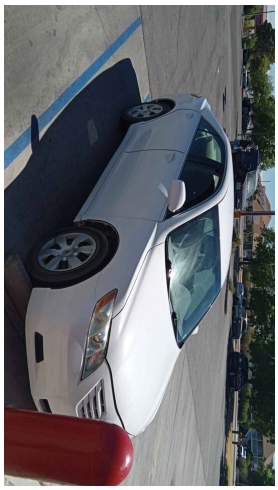
Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/27415202271474357/

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder







Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$5,683	**$449**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 10 recalls · 1,412 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$5,000.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$462.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$32.50
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$5,683.00
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$683.00
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$13.69
Total interest over the loan	$138.16
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$13.69
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$190.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$95.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.21
Total per month	$448.89

Running costs without the loan: **$435/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,103** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good overall - Camrys of this generation commonly pass 200k - but the 2007-2009 2.4L 4-cylinder is known for burning oil, and the dashboards of 2007-2011 Camrys can melt and get sticky in desert heat.

NHTSA data for this model year: 10 recalls · 1,412 owner complaints (160 involving a crash). Most complaints: Vehicle Speed Control (285), Structure (241), Engine (219), Unknown Or Other (183), Service Brakes (166), Visibility/Wiper (100).

Known issues for this model

• 2.4L (2AZ-FE) oil consumption from piston rings (2007-2009); Toyota's extended coverage has expired

• Sticky/melting dashboard in heat (2007-2011)

• Water pump leaks

• Recalls (10): accelerator pedal / floor mat entrapment, power-window switch can overheat, brake-light switch (2009 build dates) - confirm done by VIN

Check on this car before buying

• Which engine? Check oil level and ask how often it needs topping up

• Look for blue exhaust smoke at startup

• Inspect the dashboard surface

• Run VIN at a Toyota dealer for open recalls (free)

• Seller must provide a smog certificate

Notes

$5,000 OBO, 148k mi. Condition 'Used - Fair', 'up to date on maintenance'. Listed ~15 weeks. Very short listing: ask for trim/engine (2.4L 4-cyl vs 3.5L V6), title status, smog, service records, photos of dash.

Budget backup: cheap and Toyota-durable, but ~21 city MPG costs more in gas than the Fit/Mazda.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.